TELLING A CLEAR STORY

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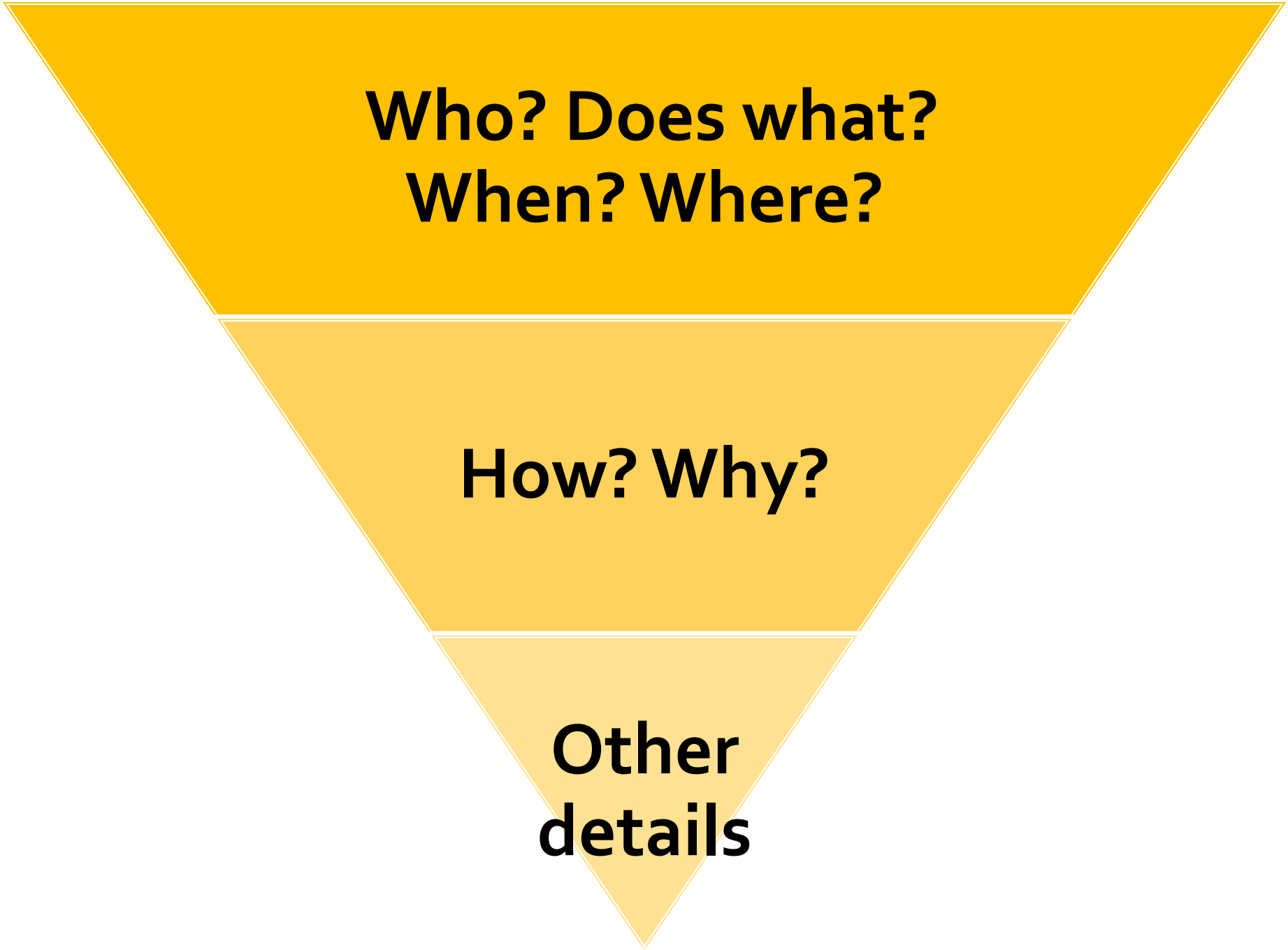
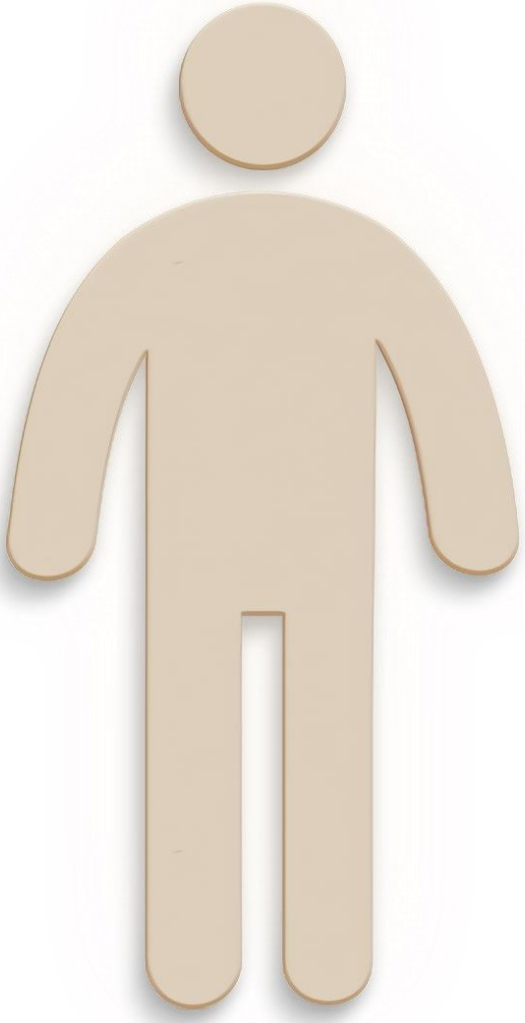
- Music is a fundamental communication channel (**Macdonald, Hargreaves & Miell, 2002**).
- Through music, people are able to share information that cannot be shared through words (**Lull, 1985**).
- The music someone likes tells a stranger valuable information about that person (**North & Hargreaves, 2007a, b, c, Rentfrow & Gosling, 2003**).
- Music plays a fundamental role in the socialization process of the child (**Dibben, 2002**).

What makes and what keeps artists/ bands/ festivals successful over time?

Being able
to connect with the audiences
through a good story,
that remains relevant
for many years.


Who? Does what?
When? Where?
How? Why?
Other
details

Bonduelle
Porumb boabe
DULCE ȘI CROCANT
100 g conține
Valoare energetică
334 kJ
80 kcal
Fără zahăr adăugat



Products	People
• Are made • Can be redefined any number of times (by someone else) • May be complex • Have multiple layers connected to what they offer to the users • Can be created to be used in combination with other products • Are created to offer various benefits to people	• Are born • Mature, grow, learn (influenced by others, but also because they choose to) • Are complex • Have multi-layered identities • Are part of networks that offer meaning to them • Are here to experience living
• Not self-aware	• Feelings • Needs • Desires • Hopes • Dreams • Fears

People tell themselves stories about themselves.

Personal identity is a construct that reflects

- **Biography:** birthday, birth place, parents' names, age, occupation, their life stories, the story of our family, social class, economic situation etc.
- **Ethnicity**
- **Nationality**
- **Gender identity, sexual orientation**
- **Marital status**
- **Education, performance in school, what we know**
- **Occupation, past professional activity**
- **Belonging to an association** (professional, ethnical, religious etc.)
- **Hobbys**
- **Our religious beliefs**, our family's beliefs
- **Favorite cultural products** (cultural omnivore – Peterson, 1992; supercultures – Lull, 2001)

Personal values

- Are criteria (concepts, beliefs) that people use when they decide to **act in a certain manner**.
- By referring to values, people evaluate events, people, and their actions **(Schwartz, 1992).**
- This evaluation happens on a conscious or unconscious level **(Bardi & Schwartz, 2003).**

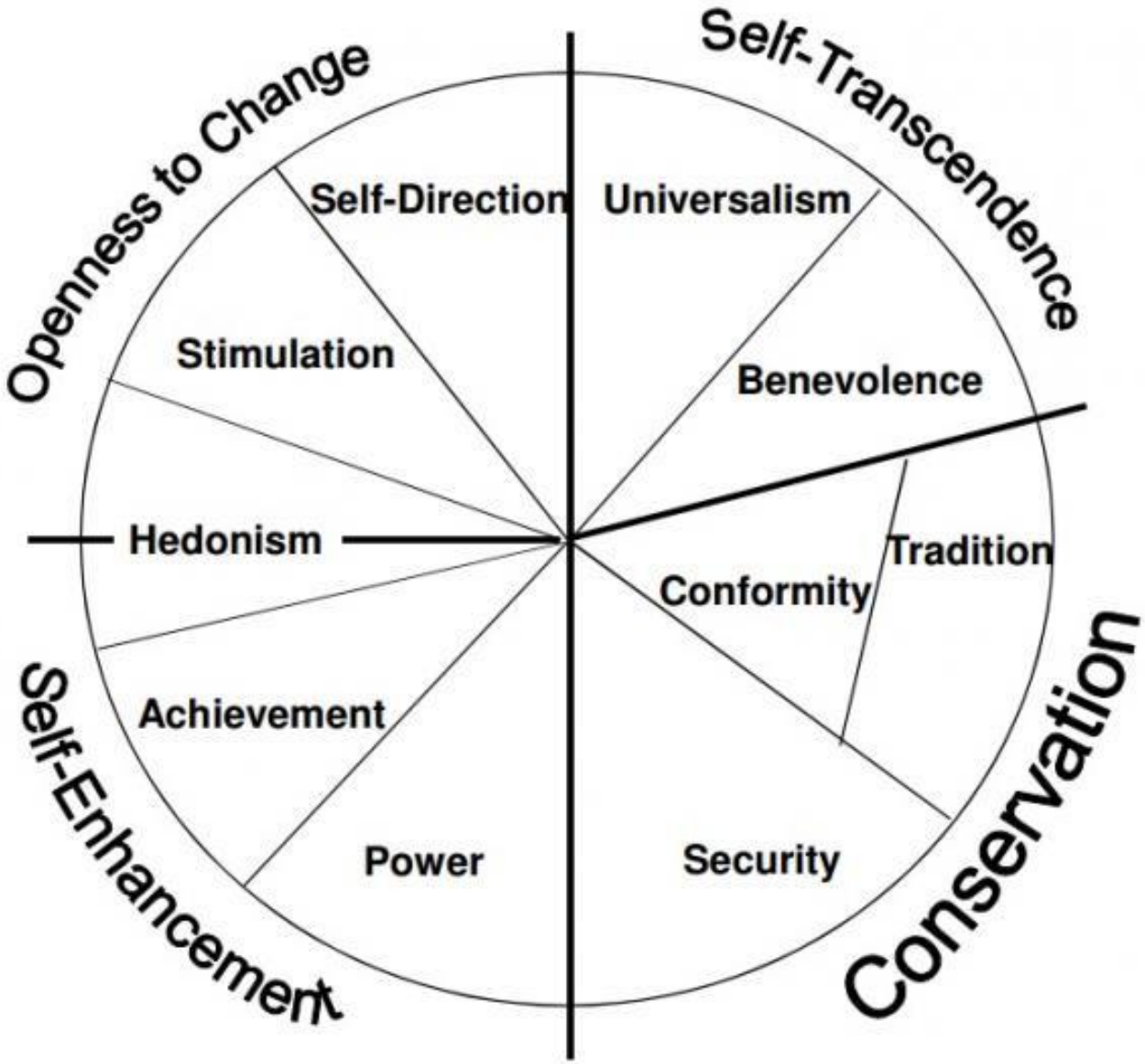


Image from: https://www.mojamba.com/schwartz-theory-of-basic-values/

The #1 factor to determine people's (consumption) choices relates to culture

Culture < lat. *colere*
= *to inhabit, to cultivate, to protect, to honour, to worship*

Culture is a network of representations – texts, images, speech, behaviours, and the narrative structures that organizes it. It shapes human experience (**Hartman, 2005**).

Culture reflects the basic values that are shared by the people within a social group.

Globalization is an ongoing process fueled by and resulting in increasing cross-border flows of money, goods, services, information, culture, and people (**Held & McGrew, 2003**).

- Is supported by the ITC development & the global media
- leads to the rise of a homogenized market segment: **the global consumers** (**Levitt, 1983**).

- **Global brands** that offer consumers across the world a standardized proposition and the same product create a **„shared habitat of meaning"** (**Hannerz, 1996**). Global brands are a symbol of shared cultural ideals. They are like a *lingua franca* for consumers all over the world (**Holt, Quelch & Taylor, 2004**).

- As globalization leads to cultural mixing and as music genres become more fluid and intertwine, as personal and group identities become more complex, the stories that music and musicians tell change (**de Nora, 2004, Negus, 2004, Shuker, 2001).**

So how do we craft a story
that is meaningful
to (potentially) global
audiences?

What is the real value we provide,
that our audience members truly need,
and that no one else does as good as we do?

What do I want my audience to remember about me?

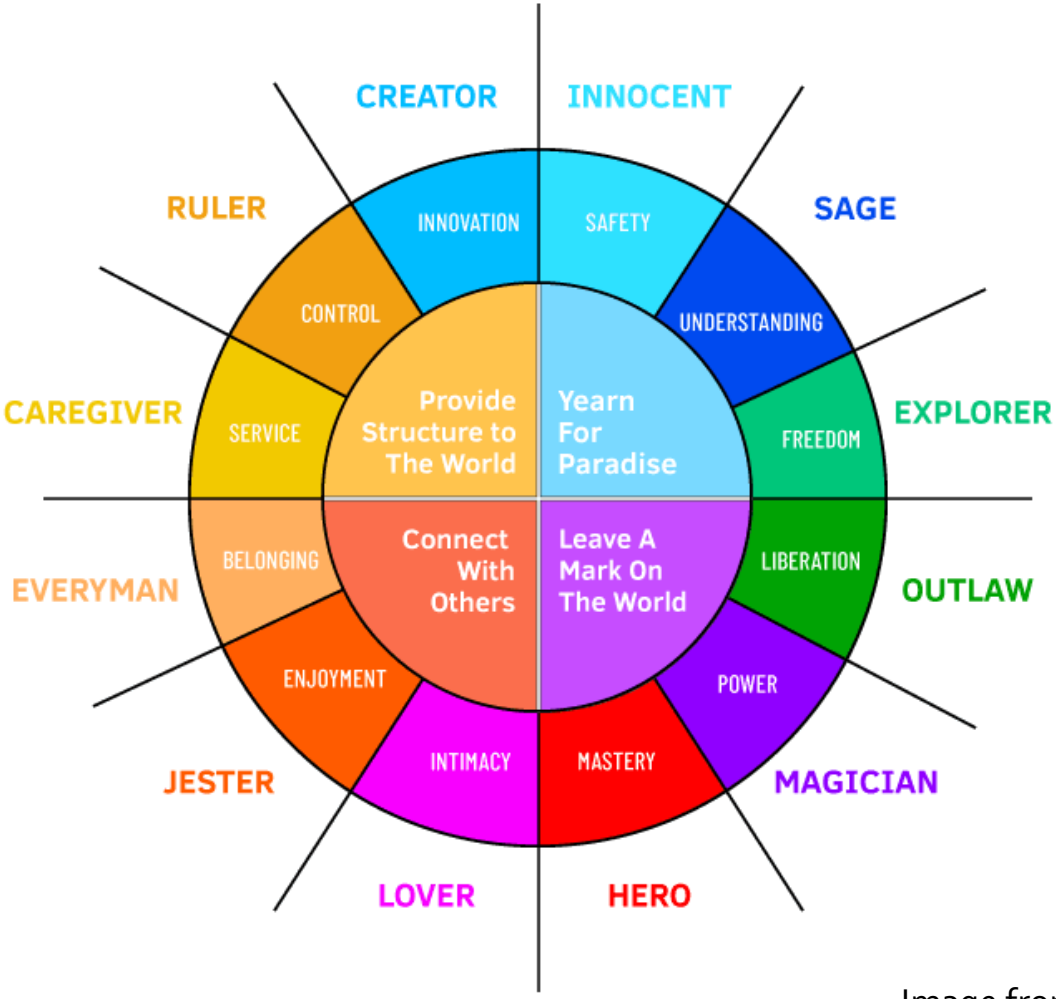
- My capacity to sing in a certain way
- My versatility with regards to the types of music I play/ make
- My capacity to bring together sounds that have not been combined before (innovative music).
- My capacity to take them back in time
- My capacity to engage with the audience in a particular manner during live shows – the way I make them feel
- My innovative shows
- My connection with my fans (online community)
- My bright mind and insightful interviews
- My beauty
- My unique way of dressing

#1 The artist tells a story that they get to own. The story is consistently presented through all related products (merch, shows, interviews etc.)

#2 The artist tells a story they belong to (credibility).

The story is consistent with preexisting elements that are linked to who the artist is in their real life.

#3 The artist embodies an archetype.



E.g.
Innocent: Birdy
Sage: Johnny Cash, Leonard Cohen
Explorer: NASA, Björk
Outlaw: Snoop Dogg
Magician: Disney, Azam Ali
Hero: Tina Turner
Lover: Marilyn Monroe
Jester: Alice Cooper
Everyman: IKEA
Caregiver: UNICEF, P&G
Ruler: Rolex, Beyonce
Creator: Mylene Farmer

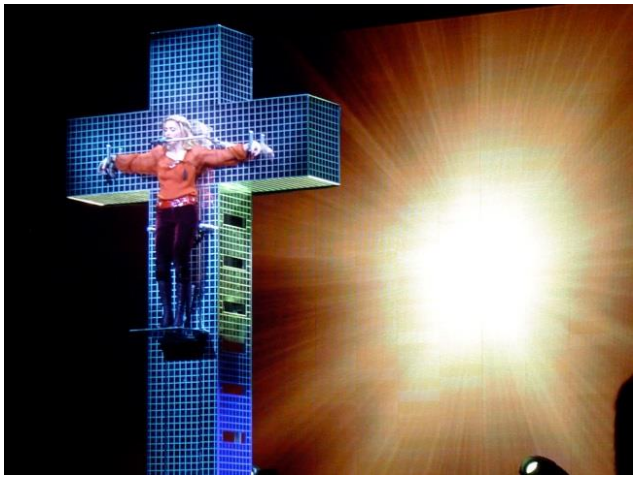
Image from: https://apricotbranding.com/the-12-brand-archetypes-how-they-can-help-you/

#4 The story is relatable.

„You can't hold me
I work my 9 to 5, better cut my check!
This goes out to all the women getting it in: you're on your grind.
To other men that respect what I do: Please, accept my shine.
Boy, you know you love it how we're smart enough to make these millions,
Strong enough to bear the children, then get back to business."

Girls, Beyoncé

#5 The story is linked to social or political phenomena (and creates controversy).



#6 The story pays tribute to other stories.

#7 The story is visually memorable.

An artist can sell well the story other artists own.

- ✓ When they present it as a product in another category (music genre). E.g. Enigma
- ✓ When they address buyers who are nostalgic. E.g. Michael Buble

Thank you!

Resources

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